

1915 South — Depth of Thinking Already Done

What an Innovation Workshop + M&A chessboard looks like when the research is already loaded.

30

STORES

6

STATES

\$182M

REVENUE

14%

EBITDA

\$25.5M

EBITDA \$

#50

US RANK

1915 South is a \$182M, 14% EBITDA Ashley licensee at an inflection point — new President, active M&A muscle, role redefinitions underway, and Ashley corporate's GMROI + AI mandate pressing from above. The question isn't whether to act. It's which moves, in what order, and with what decision layer on top.

RESEARCH FOUNDATION · WHAT'S ALREADY LOADED

22

sources analyzed in Phase 0 baseline research

30+

sources live-verified in M&A deep research

10

problem statements scoped with evidence + binding constraints

15

named acquisition targets profiled across the Southeast

8

open questions queued for the next working session

5

capital-in options modeled for Russell's optionality

A second conversation, with the homework done.

M&A TAKEAWAYS

- **2 deals closed in 3 years** — Fineman (Jacksonville, 2022) + Yulee FL (2025). Active muscle, not hypothetical.
- **~900 storefronts vacated** in 1915 South's Southeast footprint 2024–2025 (Conn's / Badcock / American Freight collapse).
- **PE home-goods deal activity up 45.5% YoY in 2025** — seller's market forming H2.
- Current operating EV anchor **~\$140–180M**; roll-up path opens real optionality at \$250M revenue.



P9 M&A + Southeast Roll-Up Play

Justin added a **VP Corporate Development & Strategy** role post-Yulee. The FRG collapse cleared the board. Without a repeatable playbook, each deal is built from scratch; with one, deal cadence and quality both rise.

TOP IDEAS ALREADY DEVELOPED

- **Southeast roll-up playbook** — target Ashley licensee gaps (SW Virginia, NC/SC) + FRG-footprint real estate
- **40-item diligence checklist + 90-day integration runbook** — codified from Yulee + Fineman muscle memory



P1 GMROI Execution Layer

Ashley corporate published the GMROI Excellence Framework Dec 2024. At 1915 South's scale, a **10% GMROI shift = \$2–4M in freed capital**. No execution layer on 30 stores × 6 states × multi-category SKU today.

TOP IDEAS ALREADY DEVELOPED

- **Regional Assortment Editor** — FL coastal / GA urban / AL rural mixes driven by data, not planogram
- **Store-level GMROI dashboard with weekly cadence** — Ashley's framework made actionable at 30 stores



P6 Sleep Vertical Launch

Justin's April 20 email: **"a lot could shift here if we open up a new line of business with sleep."** Tempur Sealy closed Mattress Firm Feb 2025 and reserved 25% of floor space for third-party brands — window opens.

TOP IDEAS ALREADY DEVELOPED

- **Sleep Lab specialty store format** — standalone branded destinations, not a corner of the furniture floor
- **Tempur Sealy 3rd-party placement access** — structured preferred-supplier conversation, post-MFRM close

+ 7 more problems fully scoped — final-mile economics, 108-year-old back-office systems, role redefinitions across the leadership team, regional demand variance · + 40+ more ideas across Format/Product, Ops/AI Arbitrage, Back-Office — fully scored, tiered, ready to sequence

01

Deeper Discovery

Surface the questions each leader already has. Align on facts before choosing direction.

02

Idea Iteration

Narrow the full ideation library to what Justin and Russell actually want to back.

03

Efficient Tests

Pilot with objective measurements — GMROI delta, attach-rate, close-days — not opinion surveys.

04

Scaled Implementation

Winners become operating reality. Losers get archived with learnings.